

Reading Strategies for the Diploma Exam:

Read → Pause → Think → Answer!

1. Graphs / Tables:

Read the title.

Pay attention to the axes. Look for the units.

Follow the arrows and lines.

Look for symbols or use of colour to emphasize important words and information.

Look at the legend or key.

Interpret the graph or table in a word format. (put it into words)

Now, look at the question and see what it is asking.

Is this a compare / contrast?

2. Context Questions:

Read the entire question and identify the key words.

Read a chunk, pause and think about what you read.

Do not skim and jump to a conclusion when you see certain words that you think lead to the correct response.

3. Diagrams:

Why is the diagram important?

How does it relate to the text box given?

Is there a sequence?

4. Calculations:

Use the Data Booklet → pages at the back.

Look up the formulas, symbols, hormone abbreviations . . .

General Strategies:

1. Reread the question. Slow down → identify and define key words (biology words).
Get the big picture. Make a mental image.
2. Rephrase things to make them easier to understand. Write a cue in the margin.
3. Manage your time carefully and do not spend too much on any one question. Allow sufficient time at the end to check that every question has been completed.

Read Highlight Think and visualize Read the diagrams Reread Go step by step Answer the question.
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